

My Favorite City

When talking about Beijing, some people might admire this city since it is the capital of China. Others may yearn to go to this city to give a glimpse of its beautiful scenic spots and imposing historical sites like the Summer Palace and the Forbidden City. However, that's not what I think of this city. For me, every time people speak of its name, I'm filled with love and passion. Beijing is my favorite city because of my precious memories of this place, its success in cultural inheritance, and a thick breath of life.

My love for Beijing stems from the memory it contains. It is my hometown, where I have lived for 18 years. My memory of four seasons is stored in this place. Scenes of golden winter jasmines heralding the beginning of spring, pink lotus sleeping on the green leaf in hot summer, red maple leaves turning the Fragrance Hill into a fiery mountain in late autumn, and thick snow weighing the branches down in chilling winter are so vivid in my mind that I can almost smell the fragrance of the blossoms and see them before my eyes. Besides the sceneries, my stories with people in Beijing also imprint on my mind. I can still remember rushing out the school gate after the final exam with my best friend, receiving encouragement from my teacher when I got a low mark, and smelling the tantalizing aroma of the red-cooked belt fish cooked by my mother when I got home. Although I attend university in different city, those memories do not vanish. Instead, they become more and more distinct, forming a sense of belonging to my hometown, which is the feeling I rarely have before leaving this city. My memory gives rise to my affection for Beijing and is also the brand that the city gives me.

I am assigning Beijing to be my favorite city not only because it is my hometown but

also because of its cultural transmission. Compared with other big cities in China like Shenzhen and Shanghai, Beijing's uniqueness consists in its profound cultural background. However, Beijing is also different from cities with cultural ambiances like Nanjing and Xian. It stands out from all the cities because it combines modern technology with the traditional culture to carry them. For instance, I once went to an exhibition in the Forbidden City that demonstrates the famous "Riverside Scene at Qingming Festival" picture. Walking inside the show was like walking into Bianjing in the song dynasty—I was immersed in the sounds of the noisy crowds and attracted by animations on the wall that illustrated the life of ancient people. Beijing's using remarkable modern technologies to display Chinese culture enchants me. In Beijing, I have had numerous experiences which impress and fascinate me with its creation and faith in showing our culture to the world. My love for Beijing's cultural inheritance leads it to be my favorite city.

Moreover, Beijing is my dream city because although it has developed rapidly in the past few years and changed a lot, a flavor of life remains. Living in Beijing, my childhood is made of the scent of baked sweet potatoes on the street corners, the shouts from peddlers of selling ice-sugar gourd in winter, and the scene of an elderly man bearing a brightly feathered bird singing merrily in its cage. Admittedly, I can rarely experience these things now since Beijing has become more modern, but Beijing uses its way to provide its citizens with the breath of life. Every morning on my way to school, I am always greeted warmly by the elderly man in my community who does not know me at all; every evening when I go back home, I can always see many neighbors standing around a chessboard table, watching a chess game silently; every time I take the subway, there will always be volunteers standing on the platform who kindly reminds me to watch my steps. These small actions make Beijing not just a place where I spend 18 years in, but a real home that offers solicitude to me. It is a

city with temperature, and I am enclosed with love in Beijing. For these reasons, Beijing is undoubtedly my favorite city.

I have been to cities as modern as New York and cities as old as Cairo. However, if you ask me what my favorite city is, I will still say Beijing without hesitation. My affection does not come from Beijing's status in China or the scenic spots and historical sites. It comes from my precious memories in this place, its success in cultural inheritance, and the thick breath of life that lures me to love this city forever.